

Why is power consumption a big talking point now with AI? Google has had massive data centers for a couple of decades now. Did people think 2000s internet ran on magic? Or did no one care because "Watching YouTube helps the greater good, AI doesn't."?

Posted by u/mmofrki • 0 points • 137 comments

"We were young, we didn't know any better. Had we known then what we know now, I personally would never have gotten online!"

Comments

u/Fantastic_Top2156 • 1 points • 2026-02-22 18:36 UTC

AI can spend less. Its up to us. We're not clever enough

u/Fantastic_Top2156 • 1 points • 2026-02-21 22:05 UTC

Because they are not smart enough. Simple. Its like when we once was smart and create CPU, end thats it, never again, just add more, add more. No invention. Multiplaying.

u/brain_on_socialism • 1 points • 2026-02-05 17:02 UTC

<https://www.bloomberg.com/graphics/2025-ai-data-centers-electricity-prices/?embedded-checkout=true>

u/Human_certified • 1 points • 2026-02-03 00:45 UTC

Data center power was already growing linearly. With AI, it's still growing linearly (yes, not exponentially), but with a steeper slope.

Overall power was already growing exponentially due to the expectation of a shift to BEVs. That's slowed down, but nobody seemed to care that we were already planning to use massively more power over the coming decades.

So the only reason they care is because they still want AI to go away, and this is one of the last arguments standing. At this point, they'll take what they can get.

u/FlightFit335 • 1 points • 2026-02-02 23:27 UTC

People just need to bitch and when the are afraid or ignorant the bitch more.

u/mmofrki • 1 points • 2026-02-02 23:36 UTC

welcome to the modern internet

u/Trip-Trip-Trip • 1 points • 2026-02-02 12:47 UTC

Why is 2 shelves of distilled per day a problem when my neighbour has been having a couple of beers a week since forever?